

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Pull up a chair and let me tell you a story.



Learning Outcome

Describe necessity, duty, advice, or strong disapproval in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write a narrative paragraph.
- I can write about beliefs and opinions.
- I can report details, reasons, or results of events or actions.

Ask your partner:

- Do you like speaking in front of a crowd?
- Would you prefer to deliver a speech or tell a funny story? Explain.





Let's Explore!

Peter invites John to a Toastmasters evening. What was John's **contribution***?

* A "*contribution*" is something you bring or give.

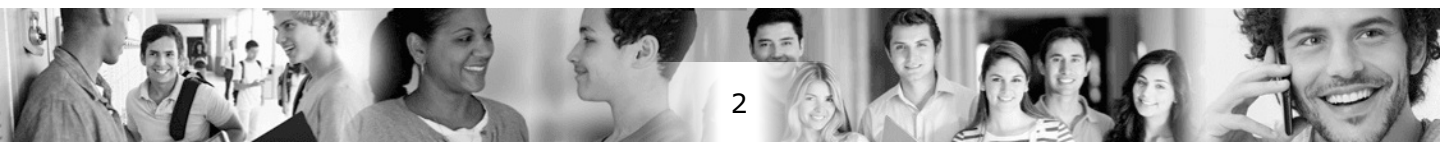


Instructions: Read the text aloud.

My name is John Harris. Thanks for having me. I've decided to tell you a funny experience that I had while traveling through Chile last year. I'm sure I'll have you all in stitches. Anyway, I had been in Santiago, Chile, for about a week. I was hanging out with some other backpackers whom I had met at the youth hostel. As 20-somethings, we had visited the performing arts centers, attended wine tastings and frequented the charming cafes that lined the streets. At night, we would enjoy Santiago's vibrant club scene. In fact, it would not be uncommon for us to be on the dance floor into the early hours. We were having the time of our lives.

One evening, a member of our trio decided to leave the nightclub earlier than usual to meet a friend. Later, I noticed that my other buddy, Josh, had left too. Consequently, I needed to find my way back to the hostel on my own at 3 a.m. I jumped on a bus outside, and was convinced that my head would be on my hostel pillow within 20 minutes. Next thing I know, I was alone and locked in the bus. It was pitch black and I had no idea where I was. I wanted to smash a window, but I didn't want to get arrested or set off any alarms. "Why are you dreaming about buses, you fool?" I muttered to myself.

I stirred again at sunrise and suddenly realized that I was in an empty bus depot. The driver mustn't have seen me stretched out on the back seat and had locked me inside. I scampered to the driver's seat, desperately searching for buttons that I had seen the driver use to open the main doors. Nothing seemed to work. My best option was to wait it out. Surely, someone would be arriving soon. Lo and behold, an early morning worker came alongside the vehicle when I was in the driver's seat. I didn't know what to do or what to say. I had no doubt that I had some explaining to do. Suddenly he shouted across the yard to his workmates, "Vengan rápido, un ladrón!"





Let's Practice!

How does John feel about his experiences?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) I 'm sure / you all / I 'll have / in stitches.
- 2) 20 minutes. / outside, / head would / on a bus / pillow within / I jumped / convinced / be on / my hostel / and was / that my
- 3) dreaming about / Do you / I am / buses? / know why
- 4) the bus / feel that / driver / I honestly / wasn't paying / attention.
- 5) As far / concerned, / as I'm / it was / experiences / one of / of my life. / the funniest



Let's Practice!

John retells his experience in Santiago, Chile.

Instructions: Circle the correct word to complete the sentence.

- 1) I didn't know **how** / **what** to do.
- 2) Did you know **who** / **what** to say when you saw the driver?
- 3) Do you know **who** / **why** he is dreaming about buses?
- 4) I tried to explain **how** / **what** the situation occurred.
- 5) Was there any reason **who** / **why** the bus driver locked me in the bus?





Extension Activity

Are you the family storyteller?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Ask your family to describe their travel experiences within your country or abroad.
- Take notes on your favorite story.
- Write a 180-200 word narrative based on your notes.
- Include a title, characters, a setting and a plot.
- Add direct dialogue to your narrative.
- Include beliefs and opinions.
- Use strong verbs and adjectives to provide engaging descriptions.
- When completed, read your narrative aloud.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I ask my family to talk about their travel experiences.

☐ ☐

I write a narrative about a travel experience.

☐ ☐

I include direct dialogue and opinions.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- lo and behold** (expression): say this to tell someone about a surprising scene, situation, or turn of events that occurred
e.g. Lo and behold, an early morning worker came alongside the vehicle when I was in the driver's seat.
- in stitches** (expression): laughing
e.g. I'm sure I'll have you all in stitches.
- pitch black** (adjective): very dark
e.g. It was pitch black and I had no idea where I was.
- hostel** (noun): an inexpensive place for usually young travelers to stay overnight
e.g. I was hanging out with some other backpackers whom I had met at the youth hostel.
- to frequent** (verb): to visit or go to a place often
e.g. We frequented the charming cafes that lined the streets.





Learning Points

Writing Tip: Position of Wh-Clause

Wh-Clauses are related to questions. You use Wh-Clauses with the words *who*, *what*, *when*, *where*, *why* and *how*. You can also use **whether** and **if** when a yes/no answer is implied.

You can use Wh-Clauses after prepositions.

*Example: The hotel receptionist consulted us **on where** we should go in the city.*

We often use Wh-Clauses in reported questions.

*Example: He asked **where** I stayed in Santiago.*

We also use to + infinitive to Wh-Clauses especially when talking about possible courses of action.

*Example: When I was in the bus, I was wondering **what to** do.*

Here are some additional examples:

Examples:

- *I didn't know what to do.*
- *Did you know what to say when you saw the driver?*
- *Did he know why he was dreaming about buses?*
- *I tried to explain how the situation occurred.*
- *Was there any reason why the bus driver locked me in the bus?*
- *Do you know whether he was able to escape the bus?*





Learning Points

Writing About Beliefs and Opinions

There are certain words and phrases that you can use when you want to express your beliefs or opinions about a subject.

Look at the chart for a list of words or expressions you can use:

Phrase	Example
I'm sure ...	<i>I'm sure I'll have you all in stitches .</i>
I believe/ maintain ...	<i>I maintain that I will have you all in stitches.</i>
As far as I'm concerned, ...	<i>As far as I'm concerned, it was one of the funniest experiences of my life.</i>
I honestly feel ...	<i>I honestly feel that the bus driver wasn't paying attention.</i>
I'm convinced that ...	<i>I jumped on a bus outside, and was convinced that my head would be on my hostel pillow within 20 minutes.</i>
I have no doubt ...	<i>I had no doubt that I had some explaining to do.</i>

